

One branch's week

A branch running at capacity. The queue, the call-out, the referral it had to turn down, and what the week added up to.

- Intake

HCHB
- Insurance & Auth

Per Diem / Float
- PCC / Scheduler

Patient
- Clinician

Branch leadership
- DCS

Trigger

Monday, 7am
the queue as it stands

1 · The Queue · Monday Morning

The queue rebuilds overnight

- a task for every discipline and again at approval
- plus one per patient awaiting approval

The scheduler opens them one at a time

- most need no action at all but each must be opened to know the day is spent finding out

Bulk clearing becomes the habit

- a rational response to the volume the one that mattered goes with it nobody can tell which

Real decisions get the time that is left

- the welcome call is one of them it slips to the afternoon or to tomorrow

Most of the day is not a decision

Administration, not scheduling
The judgment work is squeezed into what the queue leaves over.

2 · The Call-out · Wednesday, 7am

A clinician calls out at seven

- six visits on her day two are time-sensitive four could move if someone knew

Nobody can see who has room

- capacity lives in a spreadsheet updated when someone remembers and not this morning

The branch calls around

- per diem first, then contract then incentive pay for extra work whoever answers first

Covered, at a premium

- two visits covered this way two moved, two simply missed the cost lands in the month

The most expensive option is the fastest

Premium spend, bought in a hurry
Not because coverage was scarce. Because it could not be seen.

3 · A Referral Arrives · Thursday

Referral offered by the hospital

- a good fit for the branch the kind we want an answer needed today

Both admitting nurses look full

- their weeks are full of routine visits an assistant could take many no view of the assistant's week

The branch declines

- a defensible call on what is visible the wrong call on what is true the source notices

Capacity existed

- it was in the wrong hands and nobody could see it the referral goes elsewhere

Turned down with capacity in the building

An admission lost
Declined for want of capacity the branch actually had.

4 · The Week in Review · Friday

The branch reviews the week

- visits delivered, points, census all of it accurate none of it showing what was lost

Premium spend posts to the month

- without the reason attached read as a staffing problem not a visibility problem

The declined referral is not recorded

- no reason code exists for it so it never happened and cannot be counted

The week looks fine

- every number is defensible the losses are all invisible so nothing changes next week

None of this appears as a number

Invisible, therefore permanent
What cannot be counted cannot be managed, or improved.

What the week cost the branch

1 The Queue

- a day spent opening items that needed no action

2 The Call-out

- premium bought four times because nothing was visible

3 The Referral

- declined for want of capacity the branch actually had

4 The Review

- every loss invisible, so nothing changes next week

Levers on this sheet

- L1 Admission Throughput
- L2 Assessment Capacity Release
- L6 Scheduling Administration Cost
- L7 Premium Labor Avoidance